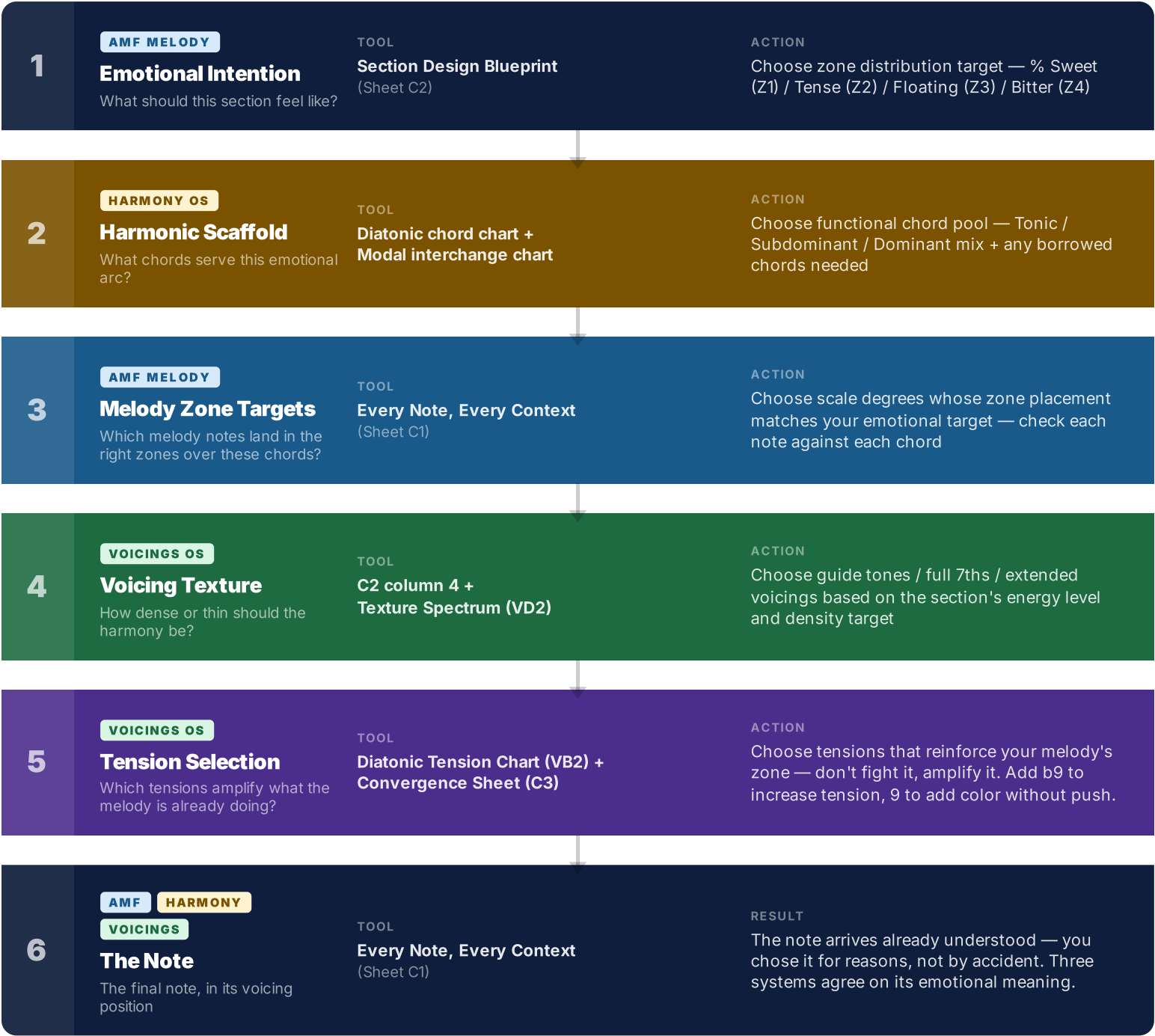


THE COMPOSER'S DECISION STACK

The order in which to apply all three systems when writing or improvising



You don't have to run through all 6 levels consciously every time. With practice, **levels 3–5 become instinct**. The stack is a scaffold to build on — a way of understanding why a note choice works, not a checklist to complete before playing. When you're stuck, start at Level 1 and work down.